

Problem 18.1

$Ax = 0$ when entries of every row of A add to 0 is $x = [1 \ 1 \ 1 \ \dots \ 1 \ 1]^T$. Since the nullspace is not the 0 vector alone, the matrix A is singular so $|A| = 0$.

If those entries of A add to 1, then those entries of $A - I$ add to 0 because the rows sum of the A get 1 subtracted thus adding to 0 instead, and so by the same logic as the original A , $\det(A - I) = 0$.

$\det(A - I) = 0$ implies $\det A = 1$.
It does not imply $\det(A) = 1$.
For example, let $A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$.

The $A - I$ has determinant 0 but A has determinant -1.

Problem 18.2

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & a^2 \\ 1 & b & b^2 \\ 1 & c & c^2 \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & a^2 \\ 0 & b-a & b^2-a^2 \\ 0 & c-a & c^2-a^2 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\downarrow$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & a^2 \\ 0 & b-a & b^2-a^2 \\ 0 & 0 & c^2-a^2-(b+a)(c-a) \end{bmatrix}$$

Matrix ^{is} $\uparrow$ in triangular form so determinant is:-
 $(b-a) \times (c^2-a^2) - (b+a)(c-a)$
 $= (b-a) ((c+a)(c-a) - (b+a)(c-a))$
 $= (b-a)(c-a)((c+a) - (b+a))$
 $= (b-a)(c-a)(c-b)$